15. Job Automation with Cronjobs

Complete Lab Guide & Command Solutions

To configure or modify your user cron schedule, open the crontab editor in terminal:

```
crontab -e
```

Task 1: Daily Timestamp Log

Runs every day at 08:00 AM and appends the current system date and time to ~/mylog.txt in your home directory:

```
0 8 * * * date >> ~/mylog.txt
```

Task 2: Weekly Directory Backup

Runs every Sunday at 11:30 PM (23:30). It ensures the destination folder exists and recursively copies the contents of 'music' from Downloads to Documents/backup_music:

```
30 23 * * 0 mkdir -p ~/Documents/backup_music && cp -r ~/Downloads/music/*
~/Documents/backup_music/
```

Note: 0 represents Sunday in standard cron syntax (7 can also be used depending on the cron daemon).

Task 3: Hourly Cleanup of .tmp Files

Runs at minute 0 of every hour. It finds all .tmp files on your Desktop, prints each deleted filename into deleted_tmp.log, and removes them:

```
0 * * * * find ~/Desktop -maxdepth 1 -name "*.tmp" -print -delete >>
~/Desktop/deleted_tmp.log 2>&1
```

Task 4: Temporarily Disabling a Cronjob

1. The original active cron job running every 2 hours:
   0 */2 * * * echo "Time for a break!"

2. To temporarily disable without deleting:
   Open crontab with 'crontab -e' and prepend the comment character (#) at the beginning of the line:
   # 0 */2 * * * echo "Time for a break!"
   Save and exit the editor.

3. To re-enable after 5 minutes:
   Open crontab again using 'crontab -e', remove the '#' comment symbol, and save the file.

```
# 0 */2 * * * echo "Time for a break!"
```

Using '#' allows preserving complex schedule configurations without recreating them from scratch.

Task 5: Weekday Evening Reminder

Runs every weekday (Monday through Friday, 1-5) at 7:45 PM (19:45) and appends 'Dinner Reminder' to dinner.txt:

```
45 19 * * 1-5 echo "Dinner Reminder" >> ~/dinner.txt
```